Incident handler's journal

Date: **Entry:**	**July 31, 2026** 1
Description	This journal entry documents a ransomware incident at a small U.S. healthcare clinic. The attack disrupted business operations and prevented employees from accessing important patient records.
Tool(s) used	Incident Handler's Journal Scenario analysis (no cybersecurity software was used)
The 5 W's	**Who** caused the incident? An organized cybercriminal group carried out the attack. They used phishing emails with a malicious attachment to gain access to the clinic's systems. **What** happened? Employees received phishing emails and downloaded a malicious attachment. The ransomware encrypted important files, displayed a ransom note, and stopped employees from accessing patient records and other business systems. **When** did the incident occur? The incident occurred on a Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. Business operations were disrupted immediately after the ransomware attack. **Where** did the incident happen? The attack occurred at a small healthcare clinic in the United States. It affected the clinic's computers, network, and patient record systems. **Why** did the incident happen? The attackers successfully used a phishing email to deliver ransomware. After the attachment was opened, the malware encrypted the clinic's files and demanded payment for a decryption key.
Additional notes	This incident highlights the importance of phishing awareness training, regular data backups, and strong email security. I would also want to know if the clinic had an incident response plan and secure backups to help recover from the attack.

Date: **Entry:**	**August 12, 2026** 2
Description	Documenting a phishing incident involving a malicious email attachment.
Tool(s) used	Threat intelligence tool for file hash investigation.
The 5 W's	Who caused the incident? The sender of the suspicious phishing email, using the name Clyde West. What happened? An employee received a phishing email with a password-protected executable file named bfsvc.exe. The file hash was previously checked and confirmed to be malicious. When did the incident occur? Wednesday, July 20, 2022 at 9:30:14 a.m. Where did the incident happen? The phishing email was sent to the company's HR mailbox. Why did the incident happen? The attacker appears to have used a fake job application to trick the HR employee into opening the malicious attachment.
Additional	The sender's email address does not match the sender name or the

notes	name used in the email. The email also contains spelling and grammar mistakes. The attachment is confirmed to be malicious, so the alert should be escalated to a Level-Two SOC analyst for further investigation.

Date: **Entry:**	August 18, 2026 3
Description	This journal entry documents a data breach involving a vulnerability in the company's e-commerce web application. The attacker was able to access customer purchase confirmation pages by modifying order numbers in the URL and collected customer personal and financial information.
Tool(s) used	Incident Handler's Journal Scenario analysis (no cybersecurity software was used)
The 5 W's	Who caused the incident? An unknown attacker caused the incident. The attacker exploited a vulnerability in the company's e-commerce web application to access customer information without authorization. What happened? The attacker performed a forced browsing attack by modifying the order number in the URL of a purchase confirmation page. This allowed the attacker to access other customers' purchase confirmation pages and collect customer PII and financial information. The attacker then exfiltrated the stolen data. Approximately 50,000 customer records were affected according to the final report. When did the incident occur? The employee received the first extortion email on December 22, 2022, at

	approximately 3:13 p.m. PT. The incident was reported to the security team on December 28, 2022, after the employee received another email containing a sample of the stolen data. The final report states that the security incident occurred on December 28, 2022, at approximately 7:20 p.m. PT. The security team investigated the incident between December 28 and December 31, 2022. Where did the incident happen? The attack occurred through the company's e-commerce web application. The attacker accessed customer purchase confirmation pages and customer transaction information through the web application. Why did the incident happen? The incident happened because the e-commerce web application contained a vulnerability that allowed users to access purchase confirmation pages by changing the order number in the URL. The application did not properly restrict access to customer information or require authentication for protected content.
Additional notes	The security team reviewed the web server and web application access logs and found an unusually high volume of sequentially listed customer orders. This helped confirm how the attacker accessed the customer data. The organization responded by notifying affected customers with help from the public relations department and offering free identity protection services. Recommended preventative measures include routine vulnerability scanning, penetration testing, URL allowlisting, and requiring authentication before users can access protected content. One discrepancy should be noted: the original scenario states that the breach affected over one million users, while the final report states that approximately 50,000 customer records were affected. This difference should be clarified before the final report is used as an official record.

Date: **Entry:**	**August 25, 2026** 4
Description	This journal entry documents my experience analyzing network traffic using Wireshark. I learned how packet captures can provide useful information about communication between systems and help analysts identify unusual activity. This activity improved my understanding of network analysis and showed me how security tools can support the Detection and Analysis phase of incident response.
Tool(s) used	I used Wireshark to analyze a packet capture file. Wireshark is a network protocol analyzer that allows security analysts to inspect network traffic. I reviewed packet information such as IP addresses, protocols, and communication details. This helped me understand how network traffic can be analyzed to identify suspicious or potentially malicious activity**.**
The 5 W's	Who: N/A for this tool-based activity. What: I analyzed a packet capture to learn how network traffic can be investigated. Where: The analysis was performed using Wireshark on the provided packet capture. When: The activity was completed during my cybersecurity training. Why: The purpose was to learn how security analysts examine network traffic and identify information that may be useful during an investigation.
Additional notes	Wireshark was new to me, and the interface initially looked overwhelming. After spending time reviewing the packets and following the activity instructions, I

	became more comfortable with the tool. I would like to continue practicing network traffic analysis to improve my skills.
Reflections / Notes	1. Were there any specific activities that were challenging for you? Why or why not? The tcpdump activity was challenging because I was still learning how to use the command line and understand the correct syntax. After reviewing the instructions and practicing again, I was able to complete the activity and became more confident. 2. Has your understanding of incident detection and response changed since taking this course? My understanding of incident detection and response has changed significantly. I now understand that incident response involves detection, analysis, containment, recovery, and documentation, as well as the use of security tools and teamwork. 3. Was there a specific tool or concept that you enjoyed the most? Why? I enjoyed learning about Wireshark and network traffic analysis the most. It was interesting to see how packets contain information about communication between systems, and I would like to continue developing my network analysis skills.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	**Entry:** Record the journal entry number.
Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. **Who** caused the incident? **What** happened? **When** did the incident occur? **Where** did the incident happen? **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.